

Human Rights & Gender

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Q: How does the RPTC capitalize on synergies that can be gained from working with Regional Organisations like the African Union rather than individual Member states especially noting that Regional Cooperation is a key factor in development

DESA and RCNYO to provide responses

DESA: While the RPTC's main purpose is to provide direct assistance to member states based on their expressed demand, the implementing entities recognize the importance to support regional cooperation, facilitate south-south cooperation and provide capacity development at the regional level on topics raised by multiple Member States. Cooperation with regional organizations such as the African Union allows the planning and conduct of joint events with speakers from both entities on common issues raised by Member States. To support the alignment between UN support and Africa's needs and priorities as well as promote a mutually reinforcing implementation between regional and global development agendas, the "AU-UN Framework for the implementation of Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development" was signed in January 2018. The framework aims at enhancing the cooperation and coordination between the United Nations and African Union in key thematic areas of significant importance to advancing progress towards the SDGs and the aspirations of Agenda 2063 by African countries, including supporting the coherent integration of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063 in national development framework; enhancing the capacity for analytical work for evidence-based policy making; data ecosystem; integrated monitoring evaluation and reporting; trade and regional integration; and the peace-development-human rights nexus.

Other examples of cooperation with regional Organization include the cooperation with specialized regional organizations. For example, International and regional organizations engaged in the tax or financing domain could be called upon to contribute to the programmes outcome with their technical expertise. These may include the African Tax Administration Forum (ATAF) and the Inter-American Center of Tax Administrations (CIAT), with both the United Nations had organized joint workshops on topics such as negotiation and application of double tax treaties, or on taxation and the correlation to the SDGs.

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Q: Does there exist under the leadership of the Executive Committee on Economic and Social Affairs or another entity a consolidated register of non-resident programmes conducted at the global, regional and country level by Secretariat entities under the RPTC, Development Account, DESA, regional commission budgets on the one hand and resident programmes conducted by resident coordinator/UNCT work on (para. 23.9)? Please provide a copy of any such register for the years 2020 and 2021

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

There is no consolidated register of non-resident programmes across financing tools under ECESA or any other entity. Information at the country level would be in the United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework and other related workplans.

Furthermore, country level information could also be found on UN INFO which is an online planning, monitoring and reporting platform that digitizes each Cooperation Framework and its corresponding joint workplans, currently covering approximately 40 results frameworks (as of April 2021) with more to come. It reflects the UN development system's effort to improve coherence, transparency and accountability, and to better address the needs and priorities of United Nations Member States. Initially conceived at the country level, UN INFO provides an overview of country level progress as well as regionally and globally aggregated information, both for the UN development system under the Cooperation Framework and individual entities. This includes how the UN development system in each country is channelling resources towards national priorities, thematic issues (including based on cross-cutting gender, human rights and humanitarian markers) and the SDGs. It encourages more regular monitoring of joint workplans so that all development activities are on track to deliver results. This enables senior leadership to make corrections to programming or shift resources in real-time. The public can also see a full picture of UN development system activities through public dashboards linked to UNCT websites.

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Q: Please provide the number of outreach activities for each entity

All entities, please provide the relevant information in the excel tables provided

Throughout the past year, UN DESA serviced numerous meetings of its Commissions, Committees and Forums such as the High-Level Political Forum, the Commission for Social Development, the Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues, the Statistical Commission, the Committee for Development Policy, etc. where outreach activities were conducted with Member States on how UN DESA can help translate the intergovernmental agreements to national implementation. Similarly, outreach activities were also conducted during global and regional capacity development workshops which were organized by the Department which also included more than 1200 virtual events. It should be noted that UN DESA does not have a mechanism to classify virtual activities into categories to obtain proper figures on its outreach activities.

For more information on the number of outreach activities, please see Annex Q27a, Q28 and Q29 outreach information.

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Q: For all GTAs approved for 2022, please provide a list indicating how many trips each GTA undertook to provide technical assistance in 2022. Also, please indicate in how many workshops/seminars they participated as providers of technical assistance.

Information on the technical assistance trips can be found in the tables below.

DESA

Title | Level | Number of Trips

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | -

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 5

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 7

Sustainable Development Officer | P-4 | 4

Chief Of Service, Sustainable Development | D-1 | 6

Principal Economic Affairs Officer | D-1 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 6

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 3

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 1

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 3

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | -

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 2

Principal Statistician | D-1 | -

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 4

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 3

Inter-Regional Adviser | P-5 | 12

Total | | 68

UNCTAD

The 6 staff funded through GTA under the RPTC undertook 8 trips to provide capacity building services.

UNODC

In 2022, the UNODC inter-regional adviser undertook nine trips in connection to technical cooperation events and advisory services.

ECA

ECA Regional Advisors Travel Information

Regional Advisors approved for 2022 per thematic areas | No. of trips each GTA undertook to provide technical assistance in 2022 | No. of workshops/ seminars each GTA participated as providers of technical assistance

Regional Adviser Macroeconomic policy and governance and economic development and planning | 16 missions

2 regional advisors, technical and support staff | 14 workshops/seminars

Regional Adviser on Regional integration and trade and private sector development and finance | 5

missions

1 regional advisor, technical and support staff | 5 Workshops/Seminars

Regional Adviser Data and statistics | 7 missions

1 regional advisor, technical and support staff | 4 Workshops/Seminars

Regional Adviser Climate change, environment and natural resources management | 4 missions

1 regional advisor, technical and support staff | 4 Workshops

Regional Adviser on Gender equality and women's empowerment and poverty inequality and social policy. | 2 missions

1 regional advisor, technical and support staff

| 2 workshops/Conference

ESCAP

ESCAP GTAs approved for 2022 | No. of trips each GTA undertook to provide technical assistance in 2022 | No. of workshops/seminars each GTA participated as providers of technical assistance

Regional Adviser on Green Financing | 3 missions | 4 workshops/seminars

Regional Adviser on Official Statistics | 4 missions

6 online advisory services | N.A.

Regional Adviser on Environment Statistics | 2 missions | N.A.

Note: date of recruitment (13.08.2022)

Regional Adviser for the North Pacific | 3 missions | N.A.

Note: date of recruitment

(07.03.2022)

Regional Adviser on South-East Asia | 4 missions

3 online advisory services | 7 workshops/seminars

ECE

Trips funded by RPTC - 35 advisory missions by Regional Advisers.

Advisory missions organized by subprogramme:

Environment - 6

Transport - 6

Statistics - 8

Trade – 3

Energy – 8

Housing – 4

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Q: In regard to the proposed resources, there are changes that need to be explained, and some are substantial. Please provide more clarity on changes in the proposed budget, at the level of sub-programmes.

21.1 Please refer to the response provided to question 14, above. In addition, the following details are provided for entities with substantial changes of resources within their subprogrammes.

DESA

21.2 The proposed resource change per sub-programme is mainly resulting from the changes in the departments' portfolio of Inter-Regional Advisors. The Department's Capacity Development Steering Committee regularly reviews the composition of its portfolio of Inter-regional Advisors in view of trends in demands for sectoral advisory services. While there is no overall resource change compared with the approved levels for 2020, the review has resulted in redeployment of resources across subprogrammes as summarized below:

21.3 Subprogramme 2 (Inclusive social development): The proposed increase is due to an additional Inter-Regional Advisor (IRA) on social development policy. The requirement to strengthen the advisory capacity in social development became apparent in the increasing need to include an advisor with proven experience on socio economic issues and policies when responding in an integrated manner to member States requests.

21.4 Subprogramme 3 (Sustainable development): A large portion of the proposed increase in resources for 2020 in other subprogrammes was made possible through a decrease in the proposed level of resources from subprogramme 3, based on a review of where the increased resources are most needed. In view of the above-mentioned review, some of the additional resources approved for 2020 remained in the sub-programme particularly to advise developing countries on the integration of the findings of their voluntary national reviews into their national sustainable development strategies, while the remaining part were redeployed to Subprogramme 2 to fund an additional IRA as well as to fund minor increases in other subprogrammes.

UNODC

21.5 The proposed increase under contractual services and consultants are based on historic expenditure patterns and would cover the requirements for completing the planned field-based projects. Based on past experience these projects require the engagement of short term local logistical support services, that are recorded under Contractual Services, rather than Grants and Contributions, as they had been budgeted in the past. Similarly, past experience has shown that increased consultant services are necessary to successfully complete the field-based projects, with fewer requirements for items charged to the Grants and Contributions class. The increases in the Contractual Services and Consultants classes, and the decreases in the Grants and Contributions classes in the proposed 2021 budget therefore reflect an adjustment to past expenditure patterns required to achieve the objectives outlined in the budget.

OCHA

21.6 The funds proposed for 2021 reflect OCHA's newly defined Policy Branch priority on horizon scanning and blue sky thinking. In particular, the Branch will undertake analysis of humanitarian trends as they intersect with the SDGs to facilitate policy and normative framework development and identify programmatic solutions. Prior to this, the Policy Branch focused on strengthening early policy work on the humanitarian and development nexus, this work is now established and has been handed over to other parts of OCHA to be made operational.

21.7 With this planned change in activity comes a change in the utilisation of resources.

Analysis and consultations will culminate in an annual Humanitarian Policy Forum hosted in New York in December. Increased travel resources would be used for funding the travel for partners in the Global South to be a part of Humanitarian Policy Forum. Resources would also be utilized to fund consultations done by staff, based on the USG's request that Policy Branch focus on delivering specific research and policy reports based on analysis of trends.

21.8 Additionally, the proposed increased resources for consultant resources would be used to hire consultants to support the analysis and planning for the Policy Forum. As dedicated resources for this specific event is needed for only a few months prior to the event, utilizing time bound consultants is a more efficient use of resources. These increases are offset by a corresponding reduction in Other staff costs, Contractual services and Fellowships grants and contributions".

ECA

21.9 The nine subprogrammes of ECA are clustered along five thematic areas: (a) macroeconomic policy and governance and economic development and planning; (b) regional integration and trade and private sector development and finance; (c) data and statistics; (d) climate change, environment and natural resources management; and (e) gender equality and women's empowerment and poverty inequality and social policy. There is no change to the overall resources proposed for 2021. Nevertheless, there is change in resources requested among sub-programmes and the reasons are the following:

21.10 Subprogramme 1, Macroeconomic policy and governance & Subprogramme 8, Economic development and planning: The decrease of \$21,700 is due to the decrease in resources for consultants (\$79,600) which is offset in part by an increase in resources for other staff (\$57,900) reflecting the subprogrammes' plan to increase focus on advisory and capacity-building activities for 2021 by leveraging synergies of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning and the subregional offices.

21.11 Subprogramme 2, Regional integration and trade & Subprogramme 3, Private sector development and finance: The increase of \$12,400 is related to the increase under other staff costs (\$30,000) to provide more timely responses to the requests of member States which is offset mainly by a decrease under consultants (\$12,700), reflecting a move towards increasing use of partnerships with other key institutions, thereby reducing the reliance on consultants.

21.12 Subprogramme 4 Data and statistics: The increase of \$58,900 is mainly owing to an increase in other staff costs (\$141,400), which reflects requirements to provide services to additional member States, offset in part by a decrease under consultants (\$31,100) and contractual services (\$47,100) reflecting the trend of low levels for these classes.

21.13 Subprogramme 5 Climate change, environment and natural resources management: The decrease of \$49,600 is due to the decrease under consultants (\$79,700) which is owing to reduced reliance on consultants. This reduction is offset in part by an increase under other staff costs reflecting the level of staffing resources needed to meet the anticipated level of requests from member States.

21.14 Subprogramme 6 Gender equality and women's empowerment & Subprogramme 9 Poverty, inequality and social policy: There is no change in the resource level compared with the appropriation for 2020.

ESCAP

21.15 The overall resource requirement for ESCAP remains unchanged between the 2020 and 2021, and some changes were proposed at subprogramme level as follows:

21.16 Subprogrammes 1, 2, 3, 5, 6 and 9: Additional funds (US\$57,200) provided to address cross-cutting issues and priorities areas in Asia-Pacific, such as in support of technical cooperation activities under the ESCAP Rapid Response Facility, and other emerging priorities.

21.17 Subprogramme 4: The reduced allocation under this subprogramme (US\$649,900) mainly reflects reallocation of resources across subprogrammes to address cross-cutting issues and priorities, including to support implementation, follow-up and review of the 2030 Agenda. Those resources were earlier accounted for under this subprogramme.

21.18 Subprogramme 7: Additional funds (US\$51,200) are provided to support highly specialized advisory services in the areas of statistics in support of the review of implementation of the 2030 Agenda and environment-related statistics.

21.19 Subprogramme 8: Additional funds (US\$255,500) provided across the five components of this subprogramme (US\$51,100 each) mainly reflects additional resources provided for addressing cross-cutting issues and emerging priority areas in Asia-Pacific, including in support of South-South Cooperation activities.

ESCWA

21.20 ESCWA's RPTC budget proposal for 2021 reflects no changes to the overall proposed resource requirements, however the resource changes proposed among the subprogrammes are attributed to the internal reform exercise, proposed in line with the Secretary-General's ongoing reforms of the United Nations, in fulfilment of the Commission's growing role as a regional substantive and normative organization. Under its resolution 335 (S-VI) of 21 December 2019, the Commission adopted a new structure to optimize its substantive and operational assets in the service of member States by reconfiguring its overall programme into six subprogrammes (climate change and natural resource sustainability; gender justice, population and inclusive development; shared economic prosperity; statistics, the information society and technology; 2030 Agenda and Sustainable Development Goals coordination; and governance and conflict prevention).

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Q: In relation to the substantive support in the area of Human Rights and the participation of indigenous people in meetings, how does this work and for which countries do you provide support, what is the relationship to the Programme/budget OHCHR?

31.1 The proposed programme budget for the RPTC for 2021, does not reflect specific result related to the participation of indigenous people in meetings. However, field activities are implemented in full cooperation with the UN Country Teams and DESA and OHCHR work closely with UN agencies such as UNDP, UN women UNICEF and UNFPA in the implementation of activities to support indigenous peoples. Furthermore, in all countries where Indigenous peoples are part of the population, OHCHR automatically invites and includes them in all the trainings and workshops across all regions, not only to the capacity building events related to specific rights of indigenous peoples. This is part of the UN policy of inclusiveness. In addition, OHCHR together with the various Regional National Human Rights Institutions and Mechanisms organize numerous

capacity building events where indigenous representatives fully participate for example with the African Commission on Human and People's Rights.

31.2 Regarding the programme and budget or RPTC and the relationship with that of OHCHR, the OHCHR continues to work on delivering its mandates with the objective to build and strengthen national, subregional and regional capacity and structures to address implementation gaps for the protection and promotion of all human rights, and in this context OHCHR activities under the regular programme of technical cooperation will provide support to Member States in building and strengthening their national and regional structures through advisory services and technical cooperation, which include a variety of field activities.

31.3 The funds approved for OHCHR under section 24 (Human rights) of the regular budget support the costs of the OHCHR staff that provide necessary expertise and knowledge, translated into research on interrelated issues mentioned above, taking into consideration regional and national specificities. OHCHR staff, funded through section 24, provide the training for government officials and policy practitioners in Geneva and in various countries and regions. This complementarity between the funds under section 24 and the RPTC funds ensures that OHCHR's continued engagement of the programme with countries from all regions translates into advisory services and technical cooperation, helping requesting countries in their human rights implementation.:

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